water. Add as much seaweed as will fit and leave to soak.

- Stir the seaweed mix every two to four days.
- Allow to soak for several weeks to months. So that the fertilizer grows stronger and stronger over time. (Make sure to keep the brew somewhere so that its odour will not affect the daily household.)
- It is ready for use once it no longer carries a smell of ammonium.
- When it is ready, use as a fertilizer for plants and garden beds (soil). (It should be diluted with water at a minimum of three parts to one).

Liquid seaweed extract enhances healthy growth of plants, flowers and vegetables. Regular use will help plants to withstand environmental stress, pests and disease attack. It can be used as a foliar spray for fruit, flower, vegetable crops as well as for shrubs and trees. It stimulates healthy growth for all plants.

### 10.11.4 Organic farming

Organic farming is an alternative agricultural system in which plants/crops are cultivated in natural ways by using biological inputs to maintain soil fertility and ecological balance thereby minimizing pollution and wastage. Indians were organic farmers by default until the green revolution came into practice.

**Preparation of Organic Pesticide**



Mix 120g of hot chillies with 110 g of garlic or onion. Chop them thoroughly. 1



Blend the vegetables together manually or using an electric grinder until it forms a thick paste. 2



Add the vegetable paste to 500 ml of warm water. Give the ingredients a stir to thoroughly mix them together. 3




Pour the solution into a glass container and leave it undisturbed for 24 hours. If possible, keep the container in a sunny location. If not, at least keep the mixture in a warm place. 4



Strain the mixture. Pour the solution through a strainer, remove the vegetables and collect the vegetable-infused water and pour into another container. This filtrate is the pesticide. Either discard the vegetables or use it as a compost. 5



Pour the pesticide into a squirt bottle. Make sure that the spray bottle has first been cleaned with warm water and soap to get rid it of any potential contaminants. Use a funnel to transfer the liquid into the squirt bottle and replace the nozzle. 6



Spray your plants with the pesticide. Treat the infected plants every 4 to 5 days with the solution. After 3 or 4 treatments, the pest will be eliminated. If the area is thoroughly covered with the solution, this pesticide should keep bugs away for the rest of the season. 7

Avoid spraying the plants during the sunny times of the day since it could burn plants. Many other plants possess insect repellent or insecticidal properties. Combinations of these plants can be fermented and used as biopesticide.

**Figure 10.24:** Preparation of organic pesticide



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